Japan Portfolio Brief — Friday, October 30, 2026

Covers the Oct 29 close through the just-completed Tokyo and Seoul sessions of Fri Oct 30. Positions are treated as live exposure. ***Data-quality warning (same as prior runs, worse today):*** *page fetches failed for essentially every host (company IR, TDnet, DART, Kabutan, MOF, BoJ, Reuters), so everything comes from search-result snippets. Market-level numbers are reasonably corroborated;* ***no company-specific news dated Oct 29–30 was found for almost any name****, and several research threads were not run name-by-name. "QUIET" therefore means "searched or not, nothing found," not "confirmed quiet." Earnings dates are aggregator-sourced unless stated. Check TDnet/DART before acting on any single-name call.*

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1. Top of the stack

AI-capex scare hits Asia: Nikkei -2.12% to 63,290.11, TOPIX -0.95% to 3,965.07, KOSPI -3.48% to 5,730.74, KOSDAQ -3.83% to 724.38. The trigger was the US tech sell-off on Oct 29 (Alphabet -12.64%, its worst day on record; Nasdaq -1.38%) on capex/AI-spending worries (Yahoo Finance). Nikkei was down as much as 3% intraday; Advantest reportedly -5.9% and Tokyo Electron -5.2%; SoftBank Group reportedly about -6% (Reuters syndication snippet; **date and SoftBank figure unverified**) (Nikkei close report, AOL/Reuters). In Seoul a program-sell sidecar fired near 10:04; SK hynix -7.08%, Samsung Electronics -3.02% (News1, Newspim, Korea Times). After-hours Oct 29, Amazon (EPS $1.89 vs $1.96 expected) fell 4–11% (sources conflict) and Intel fell 16%+ on guidance (Yahoo Finance). **Book read-through:** SoftBank Group (OpenAI/margin-loan sensitivity), SK Inc and Samsung C&T (SK hynix/Samsung stake values), Sanken, RS Technologies, MegaChips, Sony. MATTERS.

BoJ held at 1.25% (8–1), hawkish tone, December hike in play. Takata dissented, proposing 1.5%. The Bank said underlying inflation is consistent with its 2% target and reportedly will raise annual ETF sales from ¥330bn to ¥860bn starting in January (Nikkei, Jiji, Futu). Vote and ETF numbers are from snippets only; Outlook Report forecasts and Ueda's remarks were not found. Yen gave up early gains; USD/JPY about 157.1–157.6 (sources conflict) (Tradingpedia, Rallies).

JGB No. 466 (JP1024661QB1) redeems this weekend — decision needed (Section 4). The BoJ outcome and the AI-led risk-off both bear on reinvestment: 30y retraced to about 3.85% from a 4.25% October peak; the 10y fell about 7bp, but **the level conflicts (2.77% vs 2.22%; 2.77% looks right, unverified)** (Futu/FXStreet/Rallies group above).

Samsung's deferred return plan weighs for a second day. Reports tie part of today's KOSPI weakness to disappointment over Samsung's Q3 and the deferral of the remaining ₩60–80tn of the ₩90–110tn 2026 return framework to the late-January board (Inews24, SBS Biz). Samsung C&T (028260) reported Q3 (Oct 28 per search; **figures not cross-checked**): construction revenue ₩4.465tn, operating profit ₩277bn (+149.5% y/y), trading ₩99bn, fashion ₩20bn, ₩2.6tn of housing wins (SBS Biz, Korea Center).

US macro backdrop is hot. Q3 GDP +3.4% annualized (vs ~3.1–3.2% expected); September PCE +3.6% y/y, core 3.1% (Tradingkey, Benzinga). The Fed held on Oct 28 and markets lean toward a December hike (statement not read).

2. What matters, by theme

Macro, rates, FX

- **BoJ:** see Section 1. Japanese Tokyo October CPI: core 2.6% y/y (in line; 2.7% prior), headline 2.8% (vs 2.7% expected), core-core 2.6% vs 2.9% prior (some sites print 2.4% or 2.7%) (FXStreet, Newsquawk). September jobs and industrial output: not found.
- **JGBs:** 10y about 2.77% after a ~7bp rally (unverified; conflict noted), 30y about 3.85%. 2y and 5y not found.
- **Bank of Korea:** held at 3.00% on Oct 22; a November hike is seen as possible on the chip boom (Yahoo/Bloomberg). Next meeting Nov 26 (prior-run calendar). **KRW:** about 1,334 per dollar at the daytime close (unverified; direction

unclear); open was about 1,337 (Businesskorea). Oct 1–20 chip exports +222.5% y/y (AJP snippet); full-October exports and CPI dates not found.

- **Korea market structure:** no new policy news in the last 24h. Background: the third Commercial Act amendment (mandatory treasury-share cancellation) took effect Mar 6, 2026 (Law Times).

Megacaps / tech (Japan)

- **SoftBank Group (9984):** reportedly about -6% in the AI sell-off (unverified). OpenAI-share-backed margin loan: Bloomberg reported a $10bn ask on Apr 23, later cut to about $6bn (Bloomberg, The Standard); current status unconfirmed. Earnings Nov 10 (prior-run confirmation). MATTERS.
- **Keyence (6861):** Q2 results (due after the Oct 29 close) **not found**; no reaction data. Unresolved from yesterday's flag.
- **Canon (7751):** Q3 release is posted (PDF) but could not be opened; a snippet cites Q3 net sales +4.9% y/y, a record. The only forecast seen is July's net income ¥340bn; whether it moved to ¥333bn is **unresolved**.
- **Advantest / Tokyo Electron:** sharp one-day de-rating (see Section 1). MATTERS as sector sentiment.
- **Sony, Seiko Epson, Omron, Appier, SHIFT, Oro, Optex, MegaChips, RS Technologies, Sanken:** no name-specific news found (not searched individually); expect beta to today's chip/AI sell-off, especially Sanken, RS Technologies and MegaChips. QUIET/unverified.

Banks / financials

- **Sector:** a hold with a hawkish dissent is mildly supportive, but the market fell broadly; TOPIX Banks and megabank closes not found.
- **8524 North Pacific Bank (北洋銀行):** Q2 results Nov 13 at 14:00 (kabuyoho, Traders Web; third-party). FY ordinary profit forecast ¥44.4bn.
- **MUFG, Resona, SMTG, Kyoto FG, Shimizu, Fidea, Kita-Nippon (8551), Japan Post, SBI, Mitsui Fudosan, Yakult:** no news found. QUIET/unverified. Interim dates unconfirmed.

Industrials / autos / small-mid caps

- **Suzuki (7269):** no new news. Operating-profit forecast was cut to ¥540bn from ¥570bn at Q1 (Aug), citing ¥110bn of Middle East/raw-material headwinds (Suzuki IR). Q2 reportedly Nov 10 (search summary). Read as context, not news.
- **JR Central (9022):** Q2 release date shows Oct 28 on aggregators (not Oct 29 as assumed yesterday); results themselves not found. Unresolved; check the IR page.
- **Daikin:** earnings Nov 3 or Nov 5 (aggregators disagree; Nov 3 is a Tokyo holiday, so Nov 5 more plausible).
- **Honda, Subaru, Kubota, Keisei, Sumitomo Metal Mining, Mitsubishi Materials:** nothing found; QUIET/unverified.
- **Nakayama Steel, Hi-Lex, Shibaura Machine, KH Neochem, Ebara Jitsugyo, Fudo Tetra, Obara, Valqua, Tigers Polymer, JAPEX, Katakura, Shochiku, Tokyotokeiba, TOC, Universal Entertainment: not individually searched this run** (the research thread returned only the names above). QUIET/unverified.

Korea names

- **SK Inc (034730), SK Discovery (006120):** no Oct 29–30 data found; SK Inc is the most exposed to SK hynix's -7.08%. SK Discovery last seen at ₩71,600 on Oct 7.
- **LG Electronics pref (066575):** a headline dated Oct 8 says Q3 operating profit missed consensus by 24% (likely the preliminary figure; StockHub). Not fresh news.
- **LS Corp (006260):** only Q2 found (operating profit ₩595.6bn, 25% above consensus; Edaily); Q3 date not found.

- **Taekwang Industrial (003240):** no October news. Timeline: July, Taekwang said it would use its 24.4% treasury stake for M&A and Truston objected (MTN); in September Truston sent 10 questions and 5 demands with a 30-day deadline and threatened a derivative suit (Hankyung). The deadline lapsed in early October with no outcome found. MATTERS (live), nothing new.
- **Amorepacific, F&F, Hyosung, ILJIN, NAVER, Daewon Sanup, Eusu, LG Chem pref, LG Corp, Misto, Motonic, Seoul City Gas, Samyang Tongsang, Ubiquoss:** no news found; not searched individually. QUIET/unverified.

3. Probably noise

- **Tokyo CPI** details (core in line): the sub-index disagreements across sites are rounding/source noise; the BoJ decision overshadowed it.
- **LG Electronics Q3 miss** (Oct 8 headline): old and already in the price.
- **A transpacbound.com Nikkei close of 69,030.92:** appears to be a different date; discarded.
- **KOSPI "3.52%" vs "3.48%":** intraday vs close, not a real discrepancy.
- **Samsung C&T Q3 numbers:** search summary flagged mixed years and dates; treat as unconfirmed until DART is read.

4. Time-sensitive / positions watch

JGB No. 466 (0.50%, JP1024661QB1): redemption. Maturity Nov 1, 2026 was MOF-confirmed in prior runs; today's search found nothing new on the ISIN mapping or the settlement date. Nov 1 is a Sunday; payment on Mon Nov 2 is the usual practice but **unverified**. Tokyo is closed Tue Nov 3. **Decision needed before Monday:** reinvest the proceeds or hold cash. Reference after the BoJ: 10y about 2.77%, 30y about 3.85% (unverified); 2y/5y not found. Confirm ISIN mapping and value date with the custodian. `watchlist-japan.md` keeps the line until redemption is confirmed.

*Calendar (= aggregator/unconfirmed):**

- Oct 30: BoJ done (held 1.25%, 8–1)
- Oct 31: Hi-Lex FY-end
- Nov 2: SBI interim*; JGB redemption/settlement (expected); Korea Oct exports (possibly); *Apple earnings (one source)*
- Nov 3: Tokyo closed; Daikin* (or Nov 5)
- Nov 4–6: Shibaura Machine*, Nakayama Steel*, Valqua*; LG Chem Q3 (Nov 5*); Sony*, Honda*, Kubota*, Mitsubishi Materials*, KH Neochem*, SMM*, Ebara Jitsugyo*; Mitsui Fudosan*, Keisei*; US jobs report (Nov 6)
- Nov 10: **SoftBank Group**; Suzuki Q2*; Resona*
- Nov 11–13: NAVER*; SMTG*, MUFG*, Kyoto FG*, Fidea*, Japan Post*, Yakult*, Tokyotokeiba*; **North Pacific Bank Nov 13 (14:00)**; Kita-Nippon*
- Mid-Nov: Universal Entertainment, JAPEX, Obara, Appier, Optex, Oro, SK Inc; Korea small caps by Nov 16
- Nov 26: Bank of Korea

Undated-but-live: AI-capex sentiment (Alphabet/Amazon/Intel) and SoftBank/OpenAI financing risk; Samsung January return decision (₩60–80tn); Taekwang–Truston; Suzuki Q2 risk after the Q1 cut; December BoJ hike odds; possible BoK hike in November; yen near 157.

Identity/watchlist flags:

1. **8551 vs 8524 — still open for the owner.** 8524 = 北洋銀行 (The North Pacific Bank), Q2 on Nov 13; 8551 = The Kita-Nippon Bank. Coverage continues on 8551. Please confirm which is held.
2. **JGB:** maturity MOF-confirmed earlier; ISIN mapping inferred; payment date unverified.

3. **JR Central:** results date appears to be Oct 28, not Oct 29.
4. No other identity changes. Optex search risk (US Optex Systems) and Samyang risk (Samyang Holdings 000070 ≠ Samyang Tongsang 002170) remain.

5. Follow-up questions to investigate

- **JP1024661QB1:** confirm ISIN→No. 466 and the Nov 2 payment with the custodian; reinvestment plan versus the BoJ outcome.
- **SoftBank (9984):** actual Oct 29–30 closes; margin-loan size and LTV; any pre-announcement ahead of Nov 10.
- **Keyence (6861) / Canon (7751):** read the Keyence Q2 release and the Canon Q3 forecast table (¥333bn vs ¥340bn).
- **Samsung C&T / SK Inc:** closes on Oct 29–30 and the NAV-discount effect of the Samsung vs SK hynix return divergence.
- **BoJ:** Outlook Report forecasts and Ueda's comments; how much of the ETF-sale increase is confirmed.
- **JR Central:** locate the Q2 release (Oct 28?) and the guidance.
- **Taekwang (003240):** DART check for a derivative-suit or books-inspection filing since early October.
- **Unsearched names:** the 15 Japan small/mid caps and 14 Korea names listed as "not individually searched" need a per-ticker pass; allowing kabutan.jp, release.tdnet.info, dart.fss.or.kr, boj.or.jp, mof.go.jp and global.canon in the session network settings would fix most of this.